

TIPS FOR CONDUCTING RESEARCH: FINDING EVIDENCE

Find reliable sources

- Is the source trying to make you feel strong emotions?
- Is the source trying to get you to buy something?
- Does the share other places to find more information?
- Does the source share where they found the information?

Reliable sources **will** present information neutrally and **won't** try to get you to buy a solution. They will often share additional sources where you can keep reading more, or cite where they got the information they're telling to you.

Types of sources

- | | |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------|
| ✓ Non-fiction books | ✗ Blogs, essays |
| ✓ Encyclopedias | ✗ Your knowledge/ "I just know" |
| ✓ Papers by experts | ✗ Social media |
| ✓ Government websites | ✗ Movies, YouTube |

Where to Look

- Databases (Brittanica, Gale, ProQuest)
- Ask a librarian
- Search engines (Google Scholar, Science.gov)
- Encyclopedia Britannica website
- Library of Congress
- Government websites (NSF, SCDNR, FWS, NOAA)
- And more...

Always evaluate every source you use, even if they were recommended to you.

Knowing how to find and use sources

Different fields have different sources to help find information. For example:

Humanities-based

- Library of Congress
- JSTOR
- MackinVia

STEM-based

- The National Institute of Health (NIH)
- National Science Foundation (NSF)
- National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)

Using keywords from your project can help when browsing sources to help find what you're looking for!